

Kelun Biotech (6990.HK): Lung06 met primary endpoint; further validates sac-TMT as 1L NSCLC backbone

PFS superiority announced for OptiTROP-Lung06: On July 15th, Kelun Biotech announced positive topline for the China ph3 OptiTROP-Lung06 trial (1L nsq-NSCLC with PD-L1 TPS<1%) meeting the primary endpoint (PFS). In a head-to-head comparison with the SOC (pembro plus pemetrexed/platinum combo), sac-TMT/pembro combo demonstrated significantly prolonged PFS and a positive OS trend, as well as a manageable safety profile with no new safety findings. The positive topline of OptiTROP-Lung06 marks another significant China ph3 success in 1L NSCLC after the bar-setting success of OptiTROP-Lung05 (PFS HR of 0.35 in 1L NSCLC with PD-L1 TPS≥1%) at ASCO2026 (see our takeaways, [LINK](#), [LINK](#)), and more importantly provided direct evidence of superiority of sac-TMT/pembro combo over the pembro/chemo combo (vs. Lung05 trial which used pembro mono as the control arm).

Eyes on ESMO for data details, reiterate expectation of 9-12m PFS: With the positive topline announcement, we expect detailed data to be shared at an upcoming conference, noting that mgmt were considering the ESMO LBA submission (see our [Corp Day takeaway](#)). We reiterate our previous expectations of 9-12m of PFS for Lung06, based on 1) the China ph2 OptiTROP-Lung01 trial that showed 12.4m of PFS in the TPS<1% subgroup for sac-TMT/A167 combo, and 2) the incremental information from Lung05 trial that we estimated mPFS of 13-15m for PD-L1 TPS 1-49% subgroup for sac-TMT/pembro combo, with the caveat that shorter survival benefit to be expected in TPS<1% given the lower PD-L1 expression.

Another key de-risk step for global clinical plan targeting KEYNOTE-189 population: We view OptiTROP-Lung06 as a key piece for the coverage of sac-TMT in 1L NSCLC ([Exhibit 1](#)), with continued discussions on whether MRK will initiate (and how) global ph3 trials targeting the KEYNOTE-189 population (pembro+chemo in 1L NSCLC regardless of TPS, c.40% TPS<1%), and the core debate is on the extent of superiority of sac-TMT/IO combo over pembro/chemo combo in 1L NSCLC in order to secure a significant survival superiority in a global ph3 head-to-head setting. We see the **positive results of the Lung05/06 trials as incremental de-risking steps** for the discussion, with: 1) the in-direct implications from Lung05 data, in particular the strong PFS observation of sac-TMT/pembro combo in PD-L1 TPS 1-49% subgroup (HR of 0.28 over pembro mono) suggested 13-15m of mPFS, which appears favorable towards statistical significance compared to historical data of pembro/chemo duplets with mPFS range of 7-9m (see [our detailed takeaway on Lung05 subgroups](#)), and 2) the upcoming detailed data of Lung06 at ESMO to

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provide direct head-to-head superiority of sac-TMT/pembro combo over pembro/chemo. Recall that Kelun Biotech mgmt shared that the global ph3 trials of sac-TMT for 1-49% population is a matter of whether to use PD-1 or PD-1/VEGF as the combo partner, and we expect more discussion on the potential global ph3 trials for KEYNOTE-189 population with the detailed data of Lung06 coming out.

Exhibit 1: We expect OptiTROP-Lung05/06 data as key de-risk step for global ph3 trials in 1L NSCLC, with eyes on PD-L1 1-49% group

Current standard of care and mapping of ph3 sac-TMT trials in 1L NSCLC

	PD-L1 TPS $\geq$ 50% (20-35%)	PD-L1 TPS 1-49% (25-40%)	PD-L1 TPS < 1% (20-30%)
Squamous (25-30%)	Pembrolizumab (monotherapy)	Carboplatin* + paclitaxel* + pembrolizumab	Carboplatin* + paclitaxel* + pembrolizumab
Non-squamous (up to 70%)	Pembrolizumab (monotherapy)	Carboplatin* + pemetrexed + pembrolizumab	Carboplatin* + pemetrexed + pembrolizumab

* Only used in induction phase for up to four cycles (12 weeks)

TroFuse-023
TroFuse-007

OptiTROP-Lung05
OptiTROP-Lung06

Source: NCCN Guidelines

Valuation and TP changes: We adjust our 12-month target price to HK\$582.95 (prev. HK\$561.40), which is based on a risk-adjusted DCF methodology. We adjust 2027E-28E EPS from Rmb7.49/Rmb14.32 to Rmb7.51/Rmb14.46 to reflect the strengthened view on 1L NSCLC, with 1) increased POS for Lung06 from 81% to 90%, and 2) increased POS for 1L NSCLC PD-L1 TPS <50% in ex-China from 54% to 63%.

Kelun Biotech is a clinical-stage biotech company focused on developing and commercializing differentiated antibody drug conjugates (ADCs) for global patients. We believe Kelun Biotech is well-positioned to grow into a meaningful global ADC player with 1) differentiated late-stage ADCs; 2) deep R&D know-how driving pipeline expansion; and 3) extensive collaborations with MSD for global market access (3 clinical stage and 4 pre-clinical assets, and MSD as a top shareholder) and Kelun Pharma (the parent company) for China commercialization. We expect SKB264 (TROP2 ADC) to be the key driver of Kelun Biotech's future growth given: 1) the broad spectrum of indications where TROP2 has over-expression (e.g., BC/NSCLC/UC/GC), 2) the unique drug design of SKB264 could potentially deliver clinical benefits over TROP2 ADC peers as illustrated in early encouraging data, and 3) the strong leverage of MSD's expertise and network in the global market to drive clinical development and commercialization. We are Buy rated. Key risks: 1) R&D risks in developing new indications and future ADCs; 2) increasingly heated competition in ADC field; 3) limited commercial manufacturing and sales track record; 4) challenges in talent competition; and 5) alliance risks in partnership.

We have a Buy rating on Kelun Biotech. Our 12-m TP of HK\$582.95 is based on a risk-adjusted DCF methodology assuming: 1) 11% discount rate; 2) 3% terminal growth

rate; and 3) probability of success (PoS) based on industry average success rates in different stages and adjustments based on available clinical data. Key risks: 1) R&D risks in developing new indications and future ADCs; 2) increasingly heated competition in ADC field; 3) limited commercial manufacturing and sales track record; 4) challenges in talent competition; and 5) alliance risks in partnership.

6990.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$582.95	Price: HK\$498.20	Upside: 17.0%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: HK\$114.9bn / \$14.7bn Enterprise value: HK\$111.3bn / \$14.2bn 3m ADTV: HK\$448.9mn / \$57.3mn China China Pharma & Biotech M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	2,057.9	3,111.1	5,447.6	7,907.2
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	(435.3)	356.9	2,069.6	3,951.9
	EPS (HK\$) New	(1.66)	1.39	7.51	14.46
	EPS (HK\$) Old	(1.66)	1.39	7.49	14.32
	P/E (X)	NM	NM	66.3	34.5
	P/B (X)	15.4	18.3	13.4	9.0
	Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	(8.5)	25.4	94.0	140.2
		6/25	12/25	6/26E	12/26E
	EPS (HK\$)	(0.64)	(1.03)	0.27	1.56

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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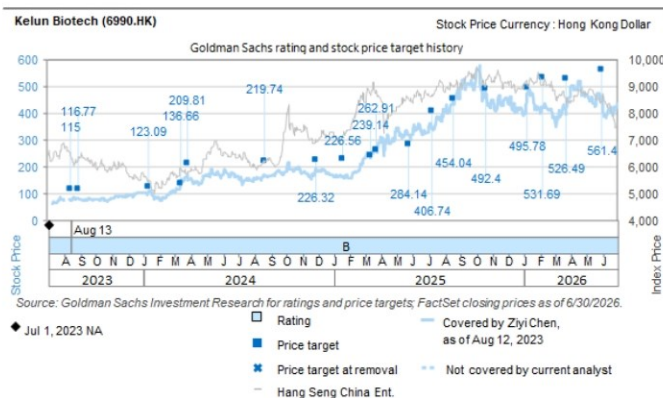
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Target price history table(s)

Kelun Biotech (6990.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
31-May-26	561.40	462.00
23-Mar-26	526.49	397.60
05-Feb-26	531.69	420.20
07-Jan-26	495.78	473.80
20-Oct-25	492.40	479.20
18-Aug-25	454.04	446.80
08-Jul-25	406.74	343.00
26-May-25	284.14	315.60
24-Mar-25	262.91	260.60
13-Mar-25	239.14	238.00
19-Jan-25	226.56	162.60
27-Nov-24	226.32	196.00
20-Aug-24	219.74	168.30
26-Mar-24	209.81	160.60
13-Mar-24	136.66	135.20
11-Jan-24	123.09	106.50
29-Aug-23	116.77	81.00
13-Aug-23	115.00	77.20

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